

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 7

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1. Appease

Meaning: To calm someone down by giving them what they want.

Tip to remember: Appease sounds like “please.” If you appease someone, you try to please them so they stop being angry.

Sentence: The manager offered a refund to appease the angry customer.

2. Arbitrary

Meaning: Based on random choice or personal whim, not reason or rule.

Tip to remember: Think of a teacher giving marks by rolling dice. That is arbitrary.

Sentence: The decision seemed arbitrary because no clear reason was given.

3. Archaic

Meaning: Very old-fashioned or outdated.

Tip to remember: Archaic sounds like “ancient.” It means belonging to an old time.

Sentence: The document used archaic words that few people understand today.

4. Clamorous

Meaning: Loud, noisy, and demanding attention.

Tip to remember: Clamorous sounds like “clamor,” which means loud noise.

Sentence: The clamorous crowd demanded justice.

5. Dearth

Meaning: A shortage or lack of something.

Tip to remember: Dearth sounds like “death.” When there is a dearth of water, crops may die.

Sentence: There is a dearth of skilled workers in the industry.

6. Explicable

Meaning: Able to be explained or understood.

Tip to remember: Explicable sounds like “explainable.” Both mean something can be explained.

Sentence: The sudden voltage drop was explicable after checking the faulty wire.

7. Hyperbole

Meaning: Exaggeration used for effect.

Tip to remember: Hyper means extra or too much. Hyperbole means saying something in an extra exaggerated way.

Sentence: Saying “I have a million things to do” is hyperbole.

8. **Immutable**

Meaning: Unchanging; unable to be changed.

Tip to remember: “Mutate” means change. Immutable means not able to mutate or change.

Sentence: The laws of physics are often treated as immutable.

9. **Indefatigable**

Meaning: Never getting tired; tireless.

Tip to remember: The word contains “fatigue.” Indefatigable means not affected by fatigue.

Sentence: Her indefatigable effort helped her master difficult GRE words.

10. **Indolent**

Meaning: Lazy and unwilling to work.

Tip to remember: Think of “in dozing mode.” An indolent person wants to sleep instead of work.

Sentence: The indolent student avoided every assignment.

11. **Insular**

Meaning: Narrow-minded or isolated from others.

Tip to remember: Insular comes from island. An island is isolated, and an insular person is mentally isolated.

Sentence: His insular attitude prevented him from understanding other cultures.

12. **Intransigent**

Meaning: Unwilling to change one’s opinion or compromise.

Tip to remember: Think of someone saying, “I will not move an inch.” That person is intransigent.

Sentence: The intransigent leader refused to negotiate.

13. **Intrepid**

Meaning: Fearless, brave, and adventurous.

Tip to remember: Intrepid sounds like “in trip.” A brave person goes on dangerous trips without fear.

Sentence: The intrepid climber continued despite the storm.

14. **Irreverent**

Meaning: Showing disrespect toward serious or respected things.

Tip to remember: Reverent means respectful. Irreverent means not respectful.

Sentence: His irreverent joke offended the elders.

15. **Loathe**

Meaning: To hate intensely.

Tip to remember: Loathe sounds heavy and negative. Think of something you hate so much that you cannot even look at it.

Sentence: She loathed dishonesty in any form.

16. **Malign**

Meaning: To speak harmful lies about someone; also, evil or harmful.

Tip to remember: “Mal” means bad. Malign means to say bad things or cause harm.

Sentence: The article tried to malign the scientist’s reputation.

17. **Malleable**

Meaning: Easily shaped, influenced, or changed.

Tip to remember: Think of soft metal that can be hammered into shape. That metal is malleable.

Sentence: Young minds are often malleable.

18. **Neophyte**

Meaning: A beginner or newcomer.

Tip to remember: “Neo” means new. A neophyte is new to a subject or activity.

Sentence: As a neophyte in coding, he started with basic Python.

19. **Plastic**

Meaning: Easily shaped or molded; flexible.

Tip to remember: Plastic material can be shaped into many forms. In GRE, plastic often means flexible or moldable.

Sentence: Children’s brains are highly plastic and adapt quickly.

20. **Platitude**

Meaning: A boring, overused statement that has little meaning.

Tip to remember: Think of a “flat attitude.” A platitude is a flat, boring saying.

Sentence: The speech was full of platitudes about hard work and success.

21. **Prescient**

Meaning: Knowing or predicting what will happen in the future.

Tip to remember: “Pre” means before, and “scient” relates to knowing. Prescient means knowing before it happens.

Sentence: His prescient warning about the market crash saved many investors.

22. **Pristine**

Meaning: Perfectly clean, fresh, or in original condition.

Tip to remember: Think of a brand-new white shirt with no stain. It is pristine.

Sentence: The hikers found a pristine lake in the mountains.

23. **Reproach**

Meaning: To criticize or express disappointment.

Tip to remember: Reproach sounds like “approach again.” Imagine someone approaching you again to scold you.

Sentence: The teacher reproached the student for being careless.

24. **Robust**
Meaning: Strong, healthy, and effective.
Tip to remember: Think of a robot built strongly. Robust means strong and reliable.
Sentence: The researcher developed a robust model for predicting demand.
25. **Salubrious**
Meaning: Healthy or good for health.
Tip to remember: Salubrious sounds like “salute to health.” It means health-giving.
Sentence: The salubrious mountain air refreshed the travelers.
26. **Sanction**
Meaning: To officially approve; or a penalty/punishment.
Tip to remember: Sanction is a tricky GRE word: it can mean approval or punishment depending on context.
Sentence: The committee sanctioned the project after reviewing the proposal.
27. **Sedulous**
Meaning: Hardworking, careful, and persistent.
Tip to remember: Sedulous sounds like “study-lous.” A sedulous student studies carefully and consistently.
Sentence: His sedulous preparation helped him improve his vocabulary.
28. **Soporific**
Meaning: Causing sleep or drowsiness.
Tip to remember: Think of a boring lecture that makes you sleepy. That lecture is soporific.
Sentence: The speaker’s soporific voice made the audience sleepy.
29. **Stern**
Meaning: Strict, serious, and firm.
Tip to remember: Think of a stern teacher who rarely smiles and enforces rules strictly.
Sentence: The principal gave the students a stern warning.
30. **Tendentious**
Meaning: Biased; strongly supporting one side of an argument.
Tip to remember: Tendentious contains “tendency.” A tendentious argument has a tendency toward one side.
Sentence: The article was tendentious and ignored opposing evidence.